

Scope and sequence: six levels of inquiry

The full curriculum map for Inquiry Academy, an online inquiry-based program for children aged 3 to 12 in China. It shows what students explore at each level and how the units build across the IB PYP themes.

Structure

18 units of inquiry across 6 levels

Kindergarten (K2–K3)

6 transdisciplinary units over two years

Grades 1–4

12 units over four years: one language, one science, and one social science unit per year

Each unit

16 lessons, each following an inquiry cycle over one week

Kindergarten Transdisciplinary units

Level 1

K2 · PYP Phase 1

Who we are

Friends and Family

Relationships contribute to shaping our identity.

How the world works

Cycles

The Earth's natural cycles influence the activity of living things.

How we organize ourselves

Systems

People organize themselves and create systems to achieve a common goal.

Level 2

K3 · PYP Phase 1

How we express ourselves

Stories

Stories contribute to our understanding of the world.

Sharing the planet

Living and Non-living Things

People make choices that have an impact on living things.

Where we are in place and time

Play

We use play to express our feelings and ideas, and to learn.

Grades 1 to 4 Subject-focused units

Language

Level 3

Grade 1 · PYP Phase 2

Who we are

All About Me

By knowing myself I can better connect with others.

Science

How the world works

Matter and Materials

Matter has states and properties that can change with processes.

Social science

How we organize ourselves

Roles We Play

To function as a community, people take on different roles and responsibilities.

Level 4

Grade 2 · PYP Phase 3

How we express ourselves

Communication

People use different forms of expression to communicate thoughts and feelings.

Sharing the planet

Mysteries of the Universe

The mysteries of the universe can be unraveled by human exploration.

Where we are in place and time

Change Through Time

Ancient civilizations are unique and paved the way for present societies.

Level 5

Grade 3 · PYP Phase 4

Who we are

Role Models

Choices of role models reflect the beliefs and values of individuals and societies.

How the world works

Simple Machines

People apply their understanding of forces and energy to invent and create.

How we organize ourselves

Economic Activity

The supply and demand of goods and services creates economic activity.

Level 6

Grade 4 · PYP Phase 5

How we express ourselves

Narrative Text

Language use reflects social and cultural contexts and connects us with others.

Sharing the planet

Biodiversity

Biodiversity relies on keeping the interdependent balance within ecosystems.

Where we are in place and time

Human Migration

Human migration is a response to challenges, risks, and opportunities.

Outlined units have full planners in this portfolio: All About Me (unit anatomy, next page) and Role Models (separate sample).

Anatomy of a unit: All About Me

Every one of the 18 units is defined with the same set of fields. Teachers who later write lesson plans, record videos, or teach live classes all start from the same clear blueprint.

Level

Level 3, Grade 1 · PYP Phase 2

Theme

Who we are

Subject focus

Language (oral and visual), with personal and social education

Central idea

By knowing myself I can better connect with others.

Lines of inquiry

- Who am I and what do I like (abilities, interests, daily habits and routines)
- Similarities and differences between ourselves and others
- How relationships contribute to self-concept

Conceptual understandings

- Spoken words connect us with others.
- People listen and speak to share thoughts and feelings.
- Individuals are unique and have personal qualities and abilities.
- Relationships require nurturing.

Key concepts

Connection

Perspective

Reflection

Learner profile

Inquirers

Risk-takers

Approaches to learning

- Thinking: acquiring knowledge
- Social: respecting others
- Self-management: healthy lifestyle

Language skills (oral language strand)

- Describe familiar people, places, things, and events, adding detail with support
- Add drawings or visual displays to descriptions
- Speak audibly and express thoughts, feelings, and ideas clearly

Learning outcomes

- Use words to communicate needs and express ideas
- Listen and respond to picture books, showing understanding through words
- Interact effectively with peers and adults, and tell their own stories
- Recognize their strengths and the qualities they want to develop
- Recognize that cooperating and respecting others supports everyone's well-being